Lesson plan · for the teacher

When to trust an agent

AI agents · Level 1 · Lesson 3

Time
40 min

Materials
Three short agent conversations written on the board or on paper (request, call, result, answer); Green, amber and red cards, or coloured chalk; The class timetable, to check against

Learning goals

- Explain why an agent can sound sure and still be wrong.
- Check an agent's call, details and result, not just its answer.
- Match trust to the stakes: green, amber, red.

Activity: Spot the slip

1. Warm-up (5 min): Ask pupils for an answer someone gave very confidently that turned out wrong (a rumour, a wrong bus time). Ask: how did we find out?
2. Teach (8 min): Write the three slips on the board: a name copied wrongly, a new way of asking misread, carrying on after a failed step. Then the four checks: which tool, which details, what came back, does the answer match?
3. Spot the slip (15 min): Show three agent conversations, each with a request, a call, a result and an answer. One is correct; two hide a slip. Groups find each slip and explain how they found it.
4. Traffic lights (7 min): Read out five jobs (find a book, the weather for a trip, a reminder for the staff, a message to parents, a pupil's mark). Groups hold up green, amber or red, and one group explains each choice.
5. Wrap-up (5 min): Agree on the rule: trust what you checked, not how it sounds. Then give the exit ticket.

Write the three conversations before class: one correct, one with a name copied wrongly in the call, one whose answer doesn't match its result. Use made-up names only.

Discussion

- Why does an agent never say "I'm not sure"?
- Which jobs at school would you rate red, and why?
- How would you teach pupils to check a helper's answer?

Exit ticket

- Name the four checks, and one job you would rate red.

Try it in class tomorrow
Play "Spot the slip": write three short agent conversations on the board, each with a request, a call, a result and an answer, and hide a slip in two of them. Pupils find each slip, then rate each job green (a quick check), amber (approve first) or red (a person decides).

Worksheet · for pupils

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Name _____ Class _____ Date _____

1 **Which of these should an agent never do on its own?**

◯ Change a pupil's mark ◯ Find a library book ◯ Look up tomorrow's weather

2 **An agent that is right about 97 times in 100 with familiar requests will be just as right when you word a request in a new way.**

◯ True ◯ False

3 **Put the checks in order, from the start of the agent's work to its answer.**

☐ Which details did it pass, and did they come from my words?

☐ Which tool did it call?

☐ Does the answer match that result?

☐ What did the tool give back?

4 **Match each job to the trust it needs.**

Look up the weather in Dala for a trip	• • • •	A person decides
Set a reminder for the whole staff	• • • •	A quick check of the result
Decide a pupil's end-of-term mark	• • • •	Read the exact message, then approve
Send a message to all parents	• • • •	You approve it first

5 **The agent says: "Done. I'll remind you on Saturday at 07:30: 6B." Its timetable call had returned "no school". Which statements are true? Choose all that apply.**

☐ Its sure tone shows the reminder is right

☐ Delete the reminder and check the timetable yourself

☐ The agent checked the result before setting the reminder

☐ The slip was there to see, in the result ☐ The reminder was built on a step that failed

Answers · for the teacher

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1 **Change a pupil's mark**

A mark is a decision about a child, so a person makes it.

2 **False**

With new wordings, Darsi Tiny falls to about 78–80 in 100, roughly four in five.

3 **Top to bottom: 2, 1, 4, 3**

Follow the agent's own steps: the call it chose, the details in it, the result the tool returned, and only then the answer built on that result.

4 **Look up the weather in Dala for a trip — A quick check of the result**
Set a reminder for the whole staff — You approve it first
Decide a pupil's end-of-term mark — A person decides
Send a message to all parents — Read the exact message, then approve

The more a mistake could harm someone, the more a person must be involved: a quick check for looking things up, your approval for actions, and a person's decision for anything about a child.

5 **The reminder was built on a step that failed; The slip was there to see, in the result; Delete the reminder and check the timetable yourself**

"No school" was a failed step, and it was visible in the result; the agent didn't check it and set a reminder anyway.

For you to think about

Think of three jobs you might give an agent at your school. Which is green (a quick check), which amber (you approve first) and which red (a person decides), and why?